

Instructor: Date:

Learner: Regional Branch:

Program: Center:

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Let's Start!

Pronunciation Spot: Time to call in help!



Learning Outcome

Describe the reasons or results of events or actions in spoken or written texts, in work and social contexts.

Ask your partner:

- Are you good at fixing household problems or do you prefer to hire someone to help? Explain.
- Have you ever gotten misleading information from a service representative? Why do you think people get the wrong information sometimes?

Can Do Statements

- I can talk about customer relations.
- I can pronounce sounds like *schwa*, and words like *repair*, and *tonight*.
- I can emphasize key information in a statement.





Let's Explore!

Vanessa gets **impatient*** about the fridge!

* "Impatient" means angry or annoyed because you have to wait.



Instructions: Read the text aloud.

Jim: Hi there, you must be Vanessa. The service representative sent me to repair your appliance.

Vanessa: Thank goodness you're here. We absolutely need to get this fridge fixed before midday.

Jim: I can't guarantee that, but I can guarantee that it will be resolved by tonight even if it means getting a new fridge.

Vanessa: Well the service rep said in no uncertain terms it would be fixed today.

Jim: That is a case of message discrepancy. Sometimes the reps have no real clue what my job entails. You have to take what they say with a grain of salt.

Vanessa: That's where the communication breaks down. The reps make assumptions and are neither educated nor trained properly. What's your guess regarding how long this will take? It's leaking brown water at the bottom and isn't cooling anything.

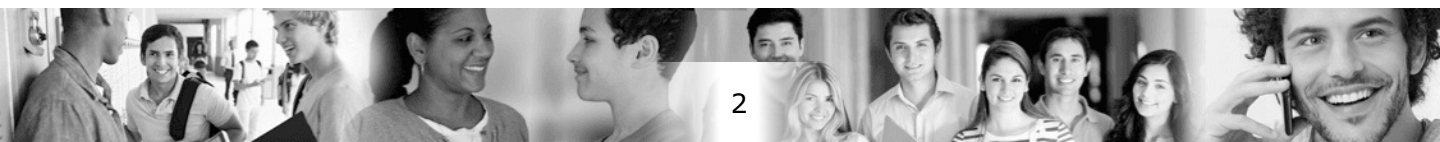
Jim: I have to check the compressor and the coils out. The worst case scenario is that we can't replace them, and that means we can have a new fridge delivered tomorrow by noon at the latest. Let's see. The coils appear to be undamaged. It seems like everything is fine except the hoses are split or cut. These will need to be replaced.

Vanessa: Great. So, can we have that done by say 2 p.m. or sooner?

Jim: I can't promise anything. I'll need to return to the shop to get the hoses that work with this make. I know it's vital to your business to have a functional appliance, but unfortunately this make is obsolete and the hoses fit differently. I have to locate a supplier that carries those hoses.

Vanessa: Okay, well, thanks. Will I see you in about an hour?

Jim: In all likelihood it'll take a little longer.





Let's Practice!

Impatient customers, like Vanessa, may become quick-tempered.

Instructions: Underline the incorrect word in the sentence. Write the correct word above the incorrect one. Read the sentences aloud. Check your pronunciation with your instructor.

1. Sometimes the reps have no real clue that my job entails.
2. I can guarantee that it will be resolving by tonight.
3. The service rep said in no uncertainlyngly terms it would be fixed today.
4. The reps make assumptions and are neither educated nor trained properlertly.
5. I'll needing to return to the shop to get the hoses that work with this make.
6. The worst case scenario is that we can't replacing the compressor and the coils.



Let's Practice!

Unfortunately for Vanessa, Jim may not be able to solve the situation until tomorrow ...

Instructions: Choose the words from the Word Bank to complete the sentences correctly.

Word Bank

undamaged / representative / tomorrow / Unfortunately / repair /
guarantee / tonight

1. The service _____ sent me to _____ your appliance.
2. I can _____ that it will be resolved by _____.
3. We can have a new fridge delivered _____.
4. The coils appear to be _____.
5. _____, this make is obsolete and the hoses fit differently.





Extension Activity

Learn about how a fridge works.

Instructions: Complete the following steps. Fill in the Self-Assessment.

- Go online and watch a video about how a fridge works.
- Take notes.
- From your notes, look up new vocabulary and highlight the words that contain the "schwa" sound /ə/.
- Tell a partner what you learned and make sure to use some of the new vocabulary.

Self-Assessment

Yes

No

I identify information from a video about how a fridge works.

☐ ☐

I take notes.

☐ ☐

I look up new vocabulary.

☐ ☐

I identify the sound "schwa" /ə/.

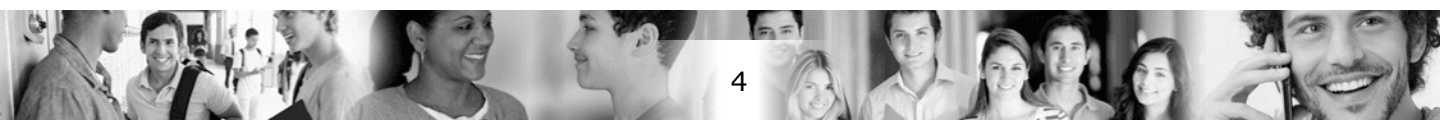
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I tell a partner what I have learned using the new vocabulary.

☐ ☐


Target Words

- in no uncertain terms** (expression): clearly
e.g. Well the service rep said in no uncertain terms it would be fixed today.
- message discrepancy** (noun): disagreement in communication
e.g. That is a case of message discrepancy. Sometimes the reps have no real clue what my job entails.
- to entail** (verb): to involve
e.g. That is a case of message discrepancy. Sometimes the reps have no real clue what my job entails.
- to take something with a grain of salt** (expression): to not assume something is an absolute truth
e.g. You have to take what they say with a grain of salt.
- compressor** (noun): a machine used to supply air or other gas at increased pressure
e.g. There is a problem with the compressor.
- coil** (noun): wire curled to form a series of circles, one above the other
e.g. I have to check the compressor and the coils.
- worst case scenario** (expression): the worst possible circumstances or outcome of a given situation
e.g. The worst case scenario is that we have to replace everything.
- at the latest** (adverb): no later than the time specified
e.g. We can have a new fridge delivered tomorrow by noon at the latest.
- likelihood** (noun): the state or fact of something's being likely or probable
e.g. In all likelihood it'll take a little longer.





Learning Points

Unstressed Vowels - Schwa: *repair, tonight*

Words in English don't always follow a regular pronunciation pattern. Some vowels are usually stressed, and some vowels are normally unstressed, like /ə/ /ʊ/ or /ɪ/.

Unstressed syllables usually contain weak vowels. You normally never stress them in words of 2 syllables or more.

Three common unstressed vowels are /ə/ /ʊ/ or /ɪ/.

/ə/ is the sound you hear in **ba**nana.

/ʊ/ is the sound you hear in particu**l**ar.

/ɪ/ is the sound you hear in Amer**i**ca.

Read the following words:

re**pre**sentative

tonight

guar**an**tee

Examples:

- *re**pre**sentative*
- *re**pa**ir*
- *guar**an**tee*
- ***to**night*
- ***co**munication*
- *unda**ma**ged*
- *un**for**tunately*
- ***to**morrow*





Learning Points

Emphatic Stress

You add emphasis in a sentence by stressing important words or by adding words to support your intention. You add different words to emphasize different things or situations.

When you decide to add emphasis, you can change the stress from the principal noun to the word you mean to emphasize. This emphatic stress adds meaning and supports the effect that you want to produce in your speech.

Example:

*That was a difficult **test**.* (Standard emphasis on the main noun.)

*That was a **difficult** test.* (Emphasis on how difficult the test was.)

Remember, when you stress a word, your intonation rises and the word is said slightly longer and louder than the other words.

Practice reading these sentences from the text:

Examples:

- **Jim:** I can't guarantee **that**, but I **can** guarantee that it will be resolved by tonight even if it means getting a new fridge.
- **Vanessa:** Well the service rep said **in no uncertain terms** it would be fixed today.
- **Jim:** Well, that is a case of **message discrepancy**. Sometimes the reps have no real clue what my job **entails**. You have to **take** what they **say with a grain of salt**.

